



FOCUS ON... BISMUTH

Bismuth has a similar weight and melting point to lead but is a much safer, non-toxic alternative.



▲ A soft bismuth alloy inside sprinklers melts during a fire, allowing the water to flow.



▲ Adding bismuth compounds to nail varnish gives it a soft pearly shine.



▲ Bismuth-based medicines are used to soothe stomach aches and indigestion.

Bismuth

83

Bi

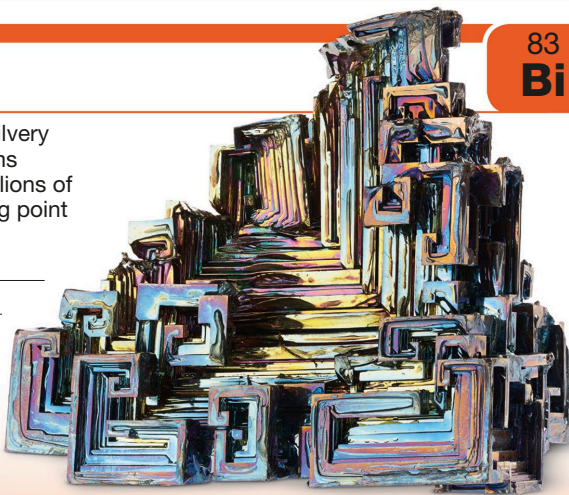
Chemists have found that this silvery metal is radioactive, but its atoms disintegrate very slowly over millions of years. Bismuth has a low melting point and creates colourful crystals.

ATOMIC MASS 208.98

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY Around 1500

**Crystals of bismuth
grown in a laboratory**



Moscovium

115

Mc

This element is produced by colliding americium with calcium atoms. Only a few atoms of it can be made at a time as they all decay away into nihonium in a fraction of a second. Moscovium was first created in 2010 in the Joint Institute for Nuclear Research (JINR) in Dubna, Russia.

ATOMIC MASS (289)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 2010 (team led by Yuri Oganessian and Kenton Moody)